

CHECKPOINT PLANNING

Financial Clarity for Life's In-Betweens

YOUR NEXT CHECKPOINT

The Inheritance Checkpoint Guide

A simple guide for the first 90 days after an inheritance.

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How to Use This Guide

This guide is designed to support you after receiving an inheritance or unexpected wealth. It offers a simple way to organize your thinking, there is rarely a need to decide anything quickly.

What this guide is:

- A tool to help you gain clarity before making decisions
- A place to capture questions and understand key deadlines
- A simple structure for your next 90 days

What this guide is not:

- A full financial plan
 - Tax or legal advice
 - Something you need to act on immediately
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Where You Are Today

An inheritance often brings a mix of emotions alongside the financial questions, relief, grief, opportunity, guilt, or all of them at once.

- What I'm feeling right now, beyond the financial questions:
- What I most want to honor or protect with this inheritance:
- What worries me most about making the "wrong" decision:

There is no need to resolve these today. Naming them is the first step toward clarity.

Five Things Worth Understanding First

1. Inherited IRA Rules

Required distribution timelines differ significantly depending on your relationship to the person who passed away, and whether they were already taking required minimum distributions. Getting this wrong can trigger unnecessary taxes or penalties.

Question to answer: Do I know which distribution rules apply to any retirement account I inherited?

2. Step-Up in Cost Basis

Inherited assets like stocks, mutual funds, or real estate typically receive a "step-up" in cost basis to their value on the date of death, which can significantly reduce capital gains tax if you sell.

Question to answer: Do I know the stepped-up basis of what I inherited, and has it been documented?

3. Inherited Real Estate

Keeping, renting, or selling an inherited home is both a financial and emotional decision. Each option has different tax, maintenance, and cash flow implications.

Question to answer: Have I weighed the true costs and benefits of keeping this property against selling it?

4. Investing the Proceeds

An inheritance doesn't need to be invested the way it was previously invested, or the way anyone else tells you to invest it. It deserves an allocation that fits your goals and risk tolerance.

Question to answer: Does my plan for this money reflect my goals, or is it just sitting in whatever account it arrived in?

5. Debt, Goals, and Balance

Paying down debt, funding goals, and investing for the future are not mutually exclusive. Most people benefit from doing some of each, in the right proportion.

Question to answer: Have I thought through the right balance for my situation, rather than doing "all" of one thing?

What I Inherited: Snapshot

Asset	Approximate Value	Tax Treatment (if known)	Any Deadline?
Retirement account (IRA / 401k)			
Brokerage / investment account			
Real estate			
Cash / bank account			
Other			

My First 90 Days Checkpoint

First 30 days, Protect

- Confirm any distribution deadlines on inherited retirement accounts
- Keep inherited funds in place; avoid spending or investing under pressure
- Identify what, if anything, has a real deadline (most things do not)

Next 30 days, Understand

- Document the cost basis of inherited assets
- Identify one professional to talk to (financial planner, tax advisor, estate attorney if needed)

Final 30 days, Decide, Thoughtfully

- Build an investment or spending plan aligned with your goals
 - Make a plan for any inherited property
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Decisions I Do Not Need to Make Yet

Almost nothing about an inheritance needs to be decided immediately. Write down what can wait.

- Decisions I can delay:
 - Earliest date these decisions need to be reviewed:
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Questions to Bring to a Professional

- Questions about inherited retirement account rules:
 - Questions about taxes on what I inherited:
 - Questions about investing or using the money:
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If You Would Like Additional Support

This guide is designed to help you gain clarity after an inheritance, at your own pace. If you'd benefit from a deeper conversation, support is available.

Schedule a complimentary Where We Begin session. It is not a financial plan and there is no obligation of any kind, a structured, confidential space to review where you are, what's changed, what decisions matter now, and what can wait.

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